

Council Meeting
March 17, 2026
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, March 17, 2026, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 5:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne - absent
Ward II Councilor William Greenrose
Ward III Councilor Christopher Irish
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Christopher Cogswell
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Nancy Bates, City Manager

CDA Members:
Andy LaFreniere
Gary Merchant
Felicia Dalke
Bob Porter
Martha Maki

NEW BUSINESS

CDA Presentation

Andrew LaFreniere, Chair of the CDA gave a presentation to Council an overview of the Claremont Development Authority, including how the board is made up, real estate, and current projects.

Councilor Koloski shared concerns with the CDA using the City’s Tax ID number, stating this limits funding coming into the City.

Manager Bates introduced Martha Maki for a finance presentation.

Martha Maki gave an overview of the Claremont Development Authority finances.

Councilor Greenrose asked when a lot is sold, how it affects the CDA and does it immediately hit the bottom line.

Manager Bates noted cash from the sale would go to the CDA bank account.

Non-Public RSA 91-A :3, II(d)

**City of Claremont
Nonpublic Session Minutes
[Claremont City Council]**

Date: March 17, 2026

Members Present

List by name
Councilor Cogswell
Councilor Greenrose
Assistant Mayor Matteau
Councilor Koloski
Councilor Limoges
Councilor Hemingway
Councilor Irish
Mayor Girard

Non-Members Invited to Attend Nonpublic Session

List by name
Nancy Bates, City Manager
Martha Maki, Bob Porter, Felicia Dalke, Martha Maki, and Gary Merchant

Motion to enter Nonpublic Session made by Assistant Mayor Matteau
seconded by Councilor Limoges.

Specific Statutory Reason cited as foundation for the nonpublic session:

RSA 91-A:3, II(d) *Consideration of the acquisition, sale or lease of real or personal property which, if discussed in public, would likely benefit a party or parties whose interests are adverse to those of the general community.*

Roll Call vote to enter nonpublic session: Majority vote required

Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 8-0

Entered nonpublic session at 6:01 p.m.

Motion to leave nonpublic session and return to public session by Councilor Hemingway, seconded by Councilor Irish. (Majority vote by roll call.)

List roll

Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 8-0

Start recording public meeting (if applicable).

Public session reconvened at 7:07 p.m.

Note: Under RSA 91-A:3, III. *Minutes of meetings in nonpublic session shall be kept and the record of all actions shall be promptly made available for public inspection, except as provided in this section. Minutes of such sessions shall record all actions in such a manner that the vote of each member is ascertained and recorded. Minutes and decisions reached in nonpublic session shall be publicly disclosed within 72 hours of the meeting, unless, by recorded vote of 2/3 of the members present taken in public session, it is determined that divulgence of the information likely would affect adversely the reputation of any person other than a member of the public body itself, or render the proposed action ineffective, or pertain to terrorism, more specifically, to matters relating to the preparation for and the carrying out of all emergency functions, developed by local or state safety officials that are directly intended to thwart a deliberate act that is intended to result in widespread or severe damage to property or widespread injury or loss of life. This shall include training to carry out such functions. In the event of such circumstances, information may be withheld until, in the opinion of a majority of members, the aforesaid circumstances no longer apply.*

Motion made to seal these minutes? If so, motion made by Assistant Mayor Matteau, seconded by Councilor Greenrose, because it is determined that divulgence of this information likely would render a proposed action ineffective;

such minutes to remain sealed unless and until the purpose for which the information discussed has been requested to be sealed no longer applies.

Roll Call Vote to seal minutes (2/3 vote required)

List roll

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

These minutes recorded by: Assistant Mayor Matteau

CDA Action Plan

56 Opera House

Mr. Lafreniere gave an update for 56 Opera House Square and noted the tenant is current for obligations and is in receipt of a grant for running their program and renovations to the second floor.

56 Opera House Roof

Mr. Lafreniere stated the roof was fairly complete and is working with the general contractor, all that is left is asbestos remediation.

Councilor Cogswell asked if the grant that was received will cover the asbestos remediation.

Manager Bates noted the grant funds are available, but Council must accept it through a CRDC grant/Brownfields project.

Councilor Koloski asked if utilizing these funds would deplete any other project in the city.

Manager Bates stated it was very specific for Brownfields.

Councilor Koloski also asked if this could deplete the ability to loan into Claremont for other projects from the CRDC.

Manager Bates will find out and bring back before Council decides on the grant acceptance.

It was noted that it will cover all the asbestos remediation.

Structure and By-laws

Mayor Girard shared his concerns for the ordinance and stated beginning of it says the CDA can enter into land deals, but near the end it says the governing body which is Council needs to approve, and feels this needs clarification.

Councilor Koloski stated the CDA has value and should remain but should establish a separate Tax ID Number. Councilor Koloski has concerns about tracking staff time, a lot of staff time is used, and suggested needing some way to track those.

Manager Bates noted, that within the bylaws it states the CDA will reimburse for staff time, but mentioned if the City were to charge them, the CDA will be in the red. Manager Bates also stated it's a huge burden on staff, being without a director and other staff it is a big concern that staff are being overloaded and bombarded with CDA work.

Mr. Lafreniere stated the CDA could approach staff differently and agrees it will be less of a burden once there is a director.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 7:29 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adjourn.

Roll call:

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council